



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	18 May 2022	Time of Incident:	0930
Region / Directorate:	IDD	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Procedural Breach	EQSafe Incident Number:	27034
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	High

Incident Short Description:	Workers observed working in a live traffic lane, without correct traffic management or barrier controls in place.
------------------------------------	---

Executive Summary:
On the 18th of May 2022 at approximately 0920hrs between Chainage 39660 and 39058. The Safety Coordinator who was traveling northbound on Tonkin Highway observed 1x subcontractor worker within a live traffic zone working on slipform without the appropriate barricade protection. The Safety Coordinator then contacted the site supervisor to inform of the breach and proceeded to the central corridor. Upon approach to the work area within the corridor, the Safety Coordinator then observed that 3 subcontractor workers had climbed over the slipform using a milk crate and had commenced patching works within a delineated lane closure adjacent to two live lanes with T-top plastic bollards used as separation. The marked speed of the highway was 80 km/h. Upon arriving to the area, the Safety Coordinator requested that the 3 subcontractor workers return over the slipform barrier using the crate that was utilised to gain access to the area initially. The supervisor attended the area, and the team was stood down from the task. Tonkin Gap Alliance Management, Main Roads Representative and Subcontractor Management were all notified of the incident.

Incident Photos:



Slipform repair



Work area access



Live traffic zone

Contributing Factors:

- Communication error between Patcher 1 and Engineer when discussing location of patching repair required in an already signed off area.
- Lack of supervision on site to allow for site inspections prior to works being completed.
- Deficiencies in training, selection and/or inexperience (System Induced Error).
- Safe work method statement (SWMS) does not contain sufficient risks and controls pertaining to Live Traffic Zones.
- Job Hazard Assessment (JHA) incomplete and considered effective where risks and insufficient controls were detailed for live traffic.

Corrective Actions:

- Contract company management to investigate supervision needs within the project to allow for adequate operation control.
- Golden Rules and "Stop Task if Unsafe" program to be communicated to entire project.
- Workers of Slipform works to undergo a full TGA reinduction to reinforce the TGA golden rules and Safety Essentials.
- SWMS review conducted and new SWMS to include more detail on working with live traffic JHA
- Accountability Matrix to be applied to Pater 1 as instructed an employee to conduct an unsafe act.
- TGA to further support the subcontractor patching team by making available the Truck Mounted Attenuator TMA to provide a physical barrier between temporary lane closure work area and live traffic.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Interaction with Live Traffic.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations